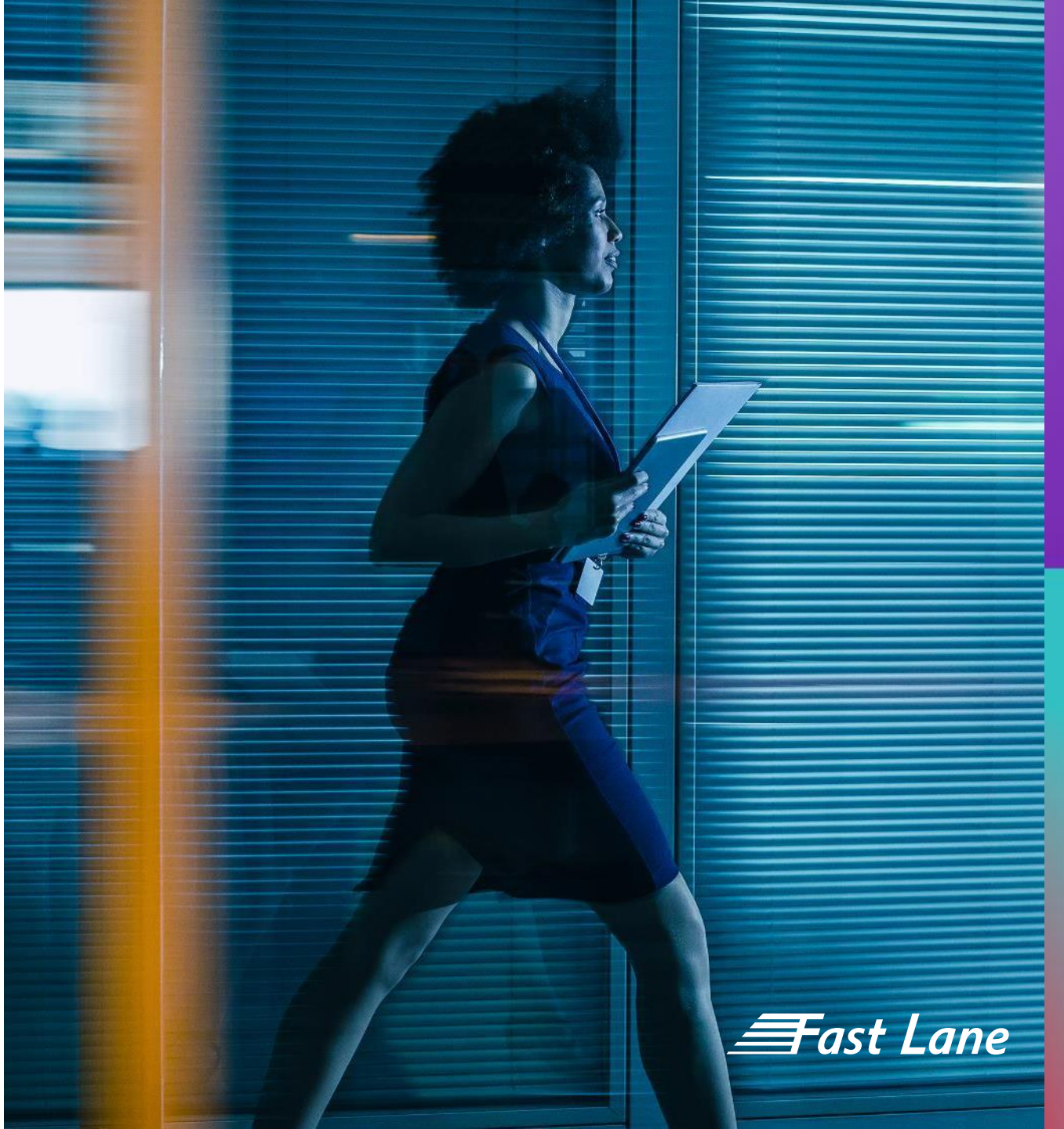
Fast Lane Group

Worldwide Education & Professional Services

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— AGENTIC AI: FROM STRATEGY TO **PRODUCTION.**

Alexander Kastil

Full stack, from enterprise software to agentic AI. Since 1996

AI at Work
Value discovery, KPI mapping and roadmap

Enterprise AI
Governed multi-agent systems on Microsoft Copilot and Foundry

Agentic Software Engineering
Harness architecture for Claude Code and GitHub Copilot

Team Enablement
AI driven content production and delivery

integrations.at
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INTEGRATIONS

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MODULE 2

Microsoft 365 Copilot Cowork

Delegate multi-step work across Microsoft 365

Automate Business Processes with Copilot Studio and Copilot Cowork



01

02

03 **Getting Started with Cowork**

What Cowork is, setup, and how a task runs

Understanding Skills: Built-in Skills & the Side Panel

The built-in catalog and the Workspace panel

Creating Custom Skills with SKILL.md

Your own skills in plain language

04

Organizing Work with Projects

Tasks, instructions and outputs in one place

05

Scheduled Prompts & Event-Driven Tasks

On a schedule or when a message arrives

06

Extending Cowork with Plugins

Outside data and expertise from plugins

Microsoft 365 Copilot Cowork

Delegate multi-step work across Microsoft 365

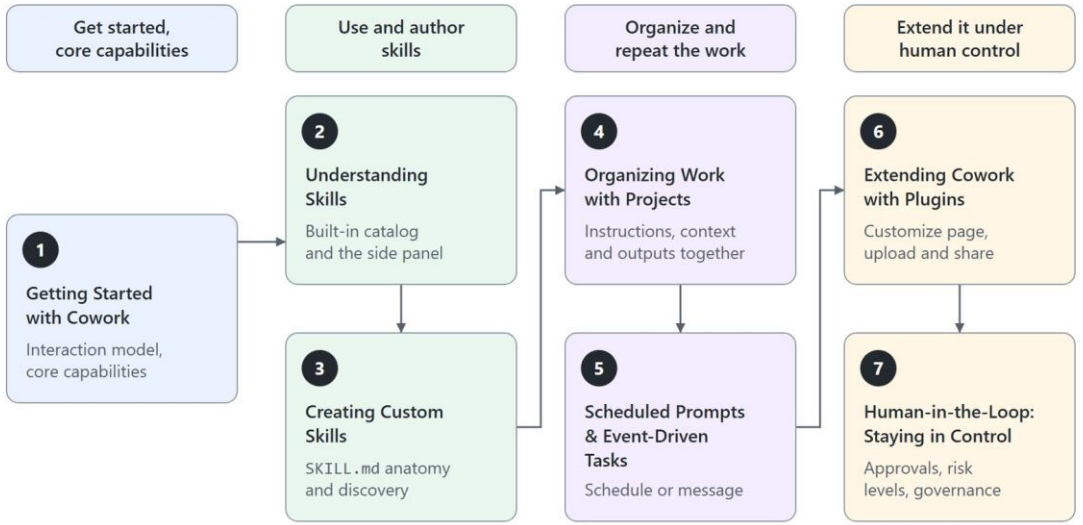
- **Delegate** an outcome in plain language, and Cowork plans and runs the steps
- **Extend** it with skills, schedules and plugins
- **Approve** before anything is sent or saved



Overview

The path through seven topics

- **Get started**: what Cowork is, how it differs from Chat, tenant setup and how a task runs
- **Use and author skills**: the built-in catalog, the Workspace panel and your own `SKILL.md`
- **Organize the work**: projects keep instructions, context and outputs together
- Make the work **recurring** with scheduled prompts and event-driven tasks
- Make it **extensible** with plugins that add external data and expertise
- Keep it under **human control** with approvals, risk levels and governance



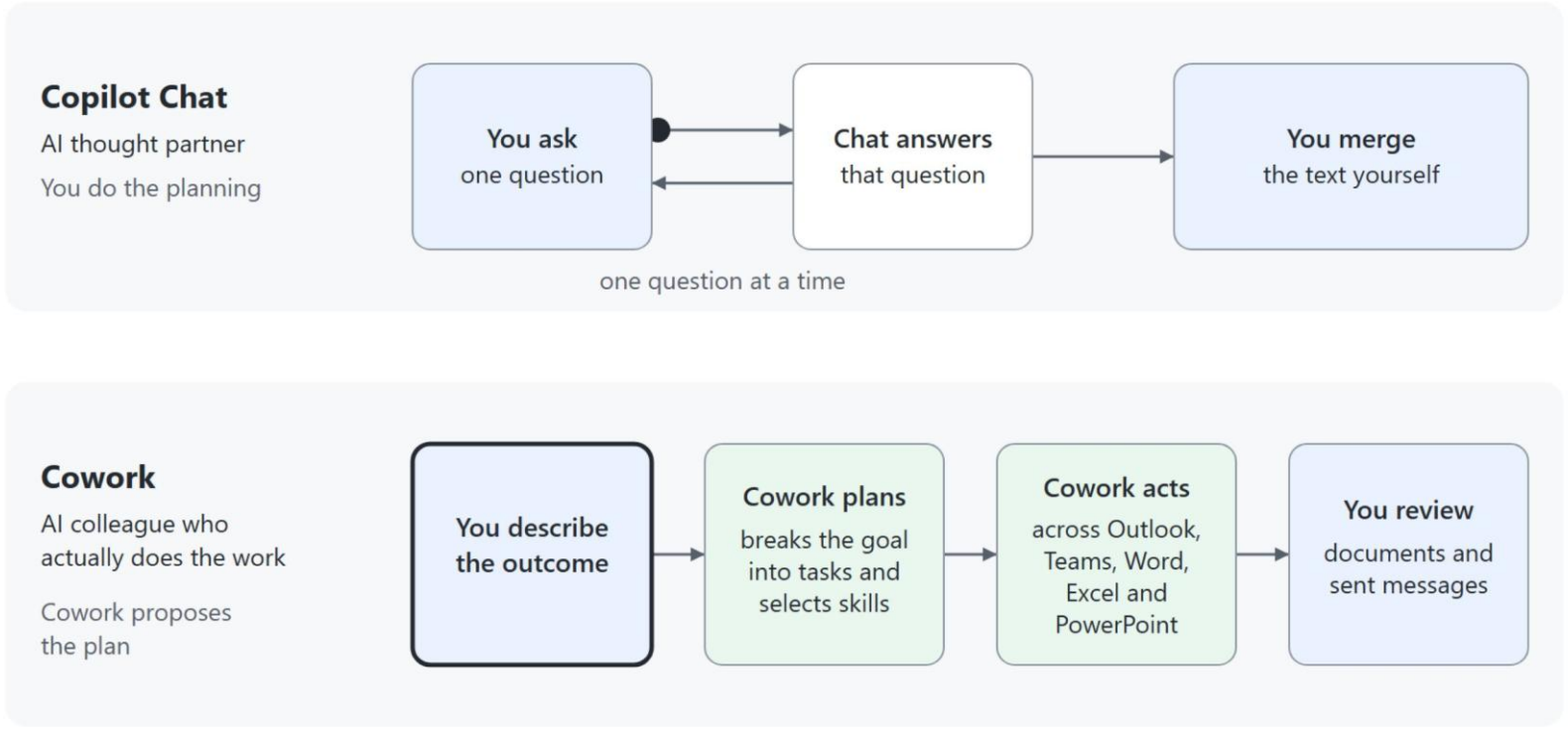
01

Getting Started with Cowork

What Cowork is, setup, and how a task runs

Cowork and Copilot Chat

Who plans the work

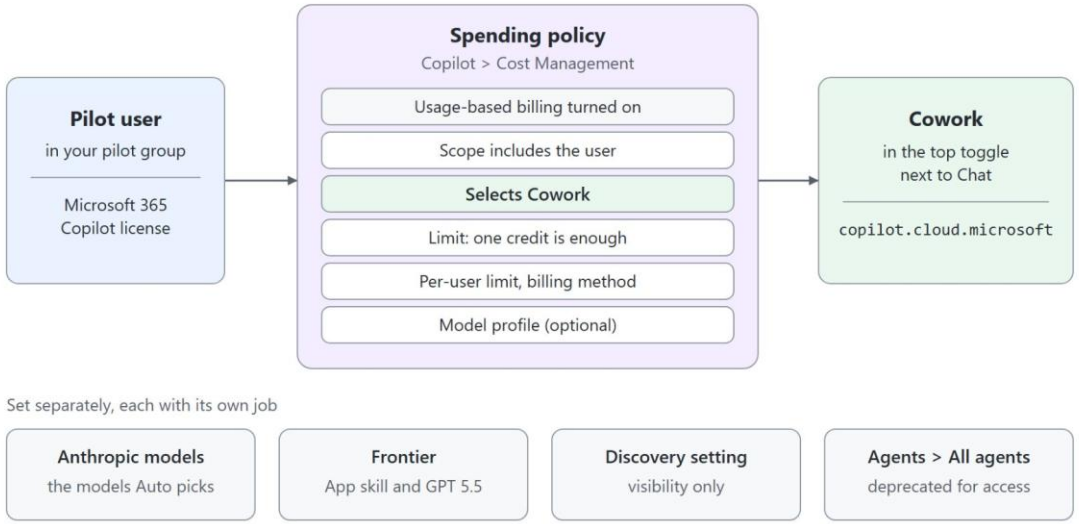


- In Chat you ask **one question at a time**; in Cowork you **describe the outcome**, and it plans and acts across Microsoft 365

Setting up Cowork access

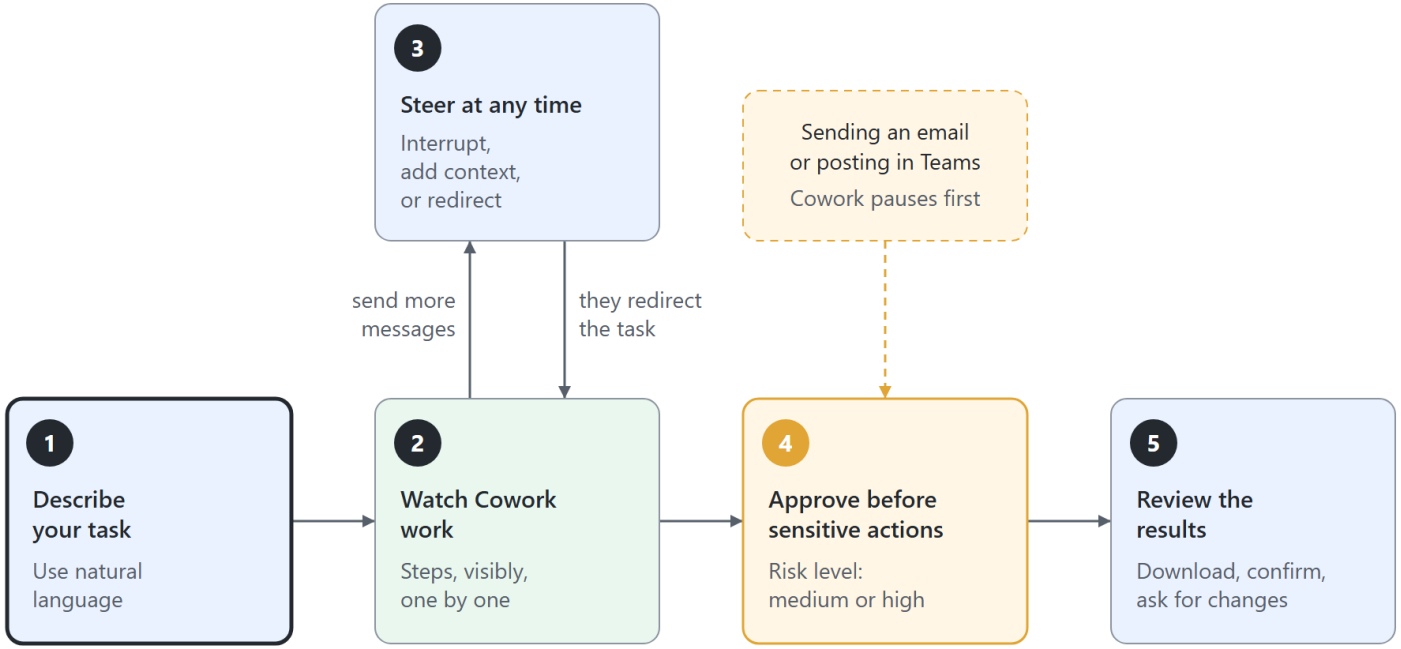
A spending policy that selects Cowork

- Every pilot user and the setup admin need a **Microsoft 365 Copilot license**
- Turn on **usage-based billing** under Copilot > Cost Management
- A **spending policy** scoped to the pilot group with Cowork selected grants access; one credit is enough
- **Anthropic models** and **Frontier** are optional for access
- The **discovery** setting controls visibility only



A typical Cowork interaction

The Q3 review deck from brief to approved send

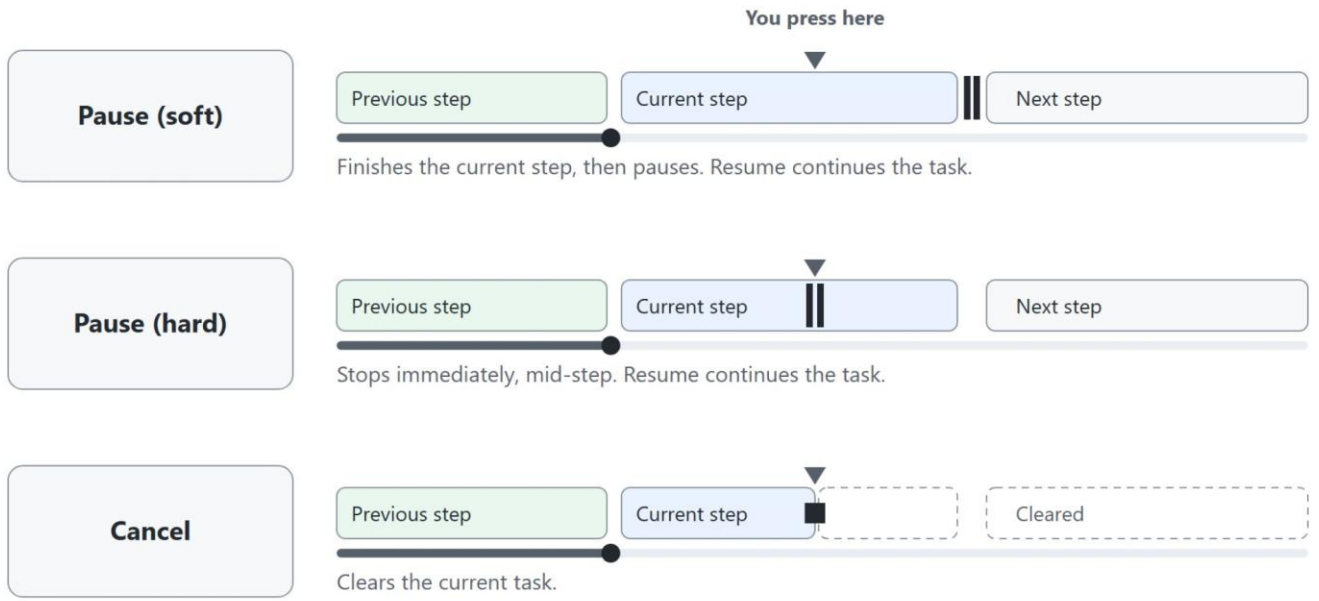


Every task runs these five steps; the Q3 review demo walks them from brief to approved send

Steering an active task

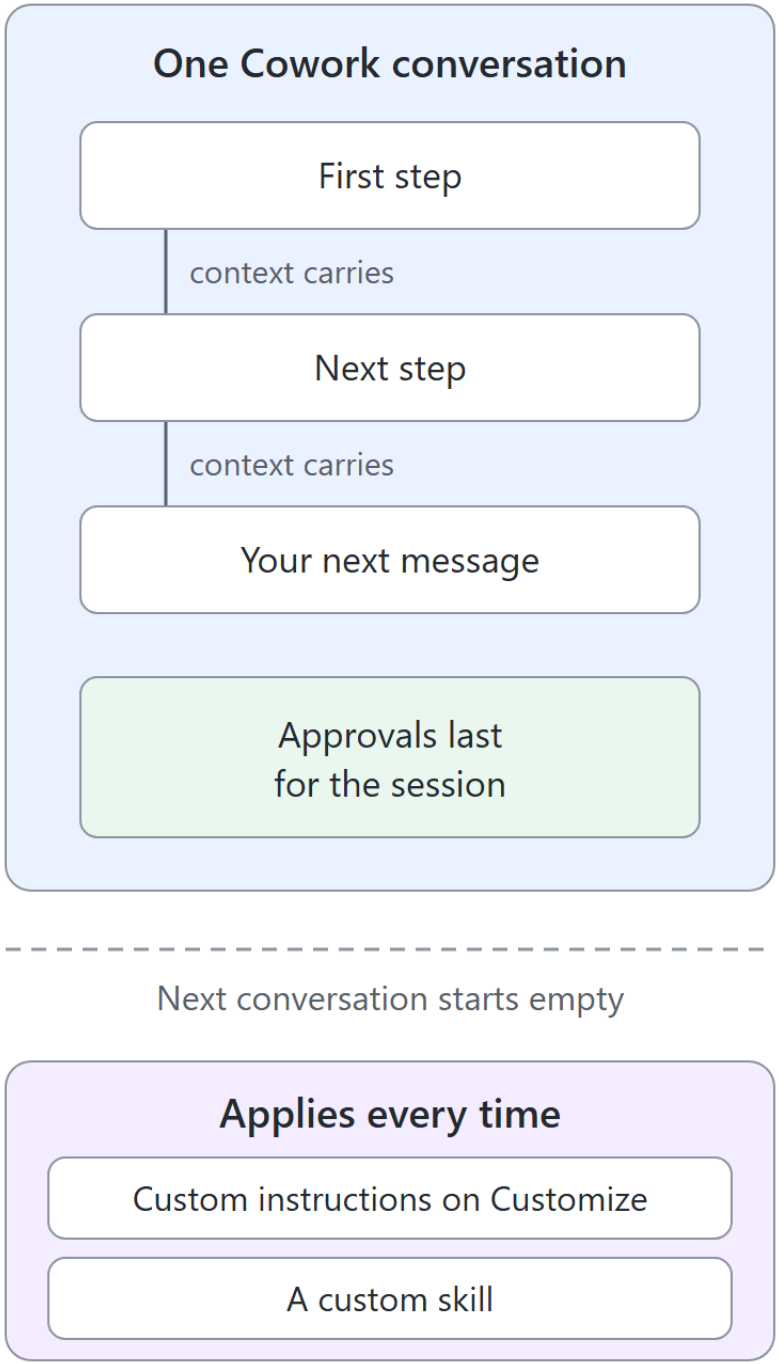
Pause, resume or cancel while Cowork works

- **Pause (soft)** finishes the current step, then pauses
- **Pause (hard)** stops immediately, mid-step
- **Resume** continues a paused task, Cancel clears the current one
- **Queued messages** sent while Cowork works can redirect it
- Rate responses and previewed documents with **thumbs up or down**, or comment inline



What Cowork remembers

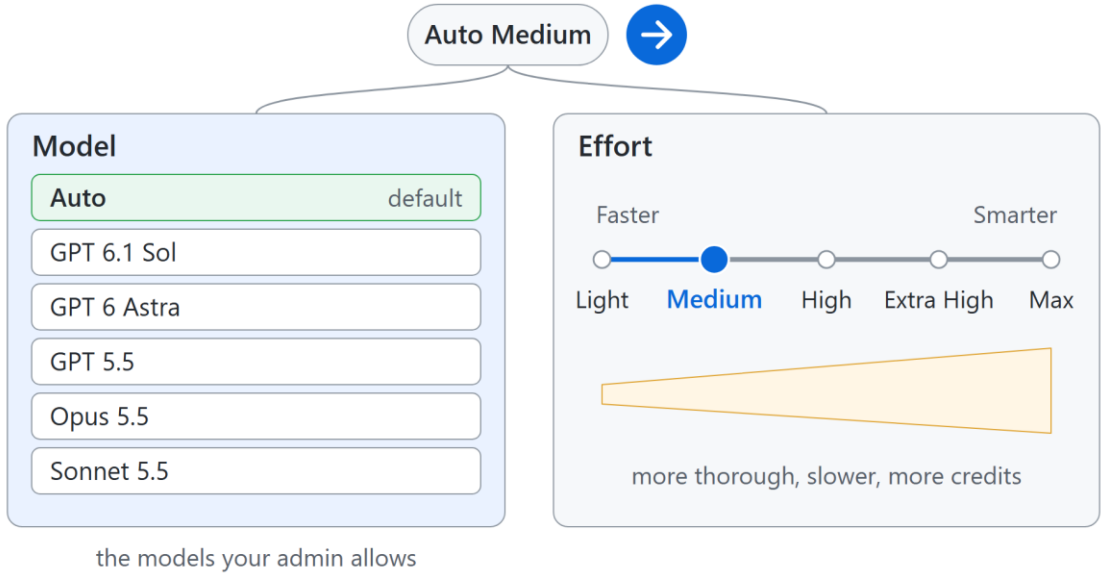
Cowork remembers for one conversation; preferences that should apply every time go into custom instructions or a custom skill



Choosing a model and reasoning effort

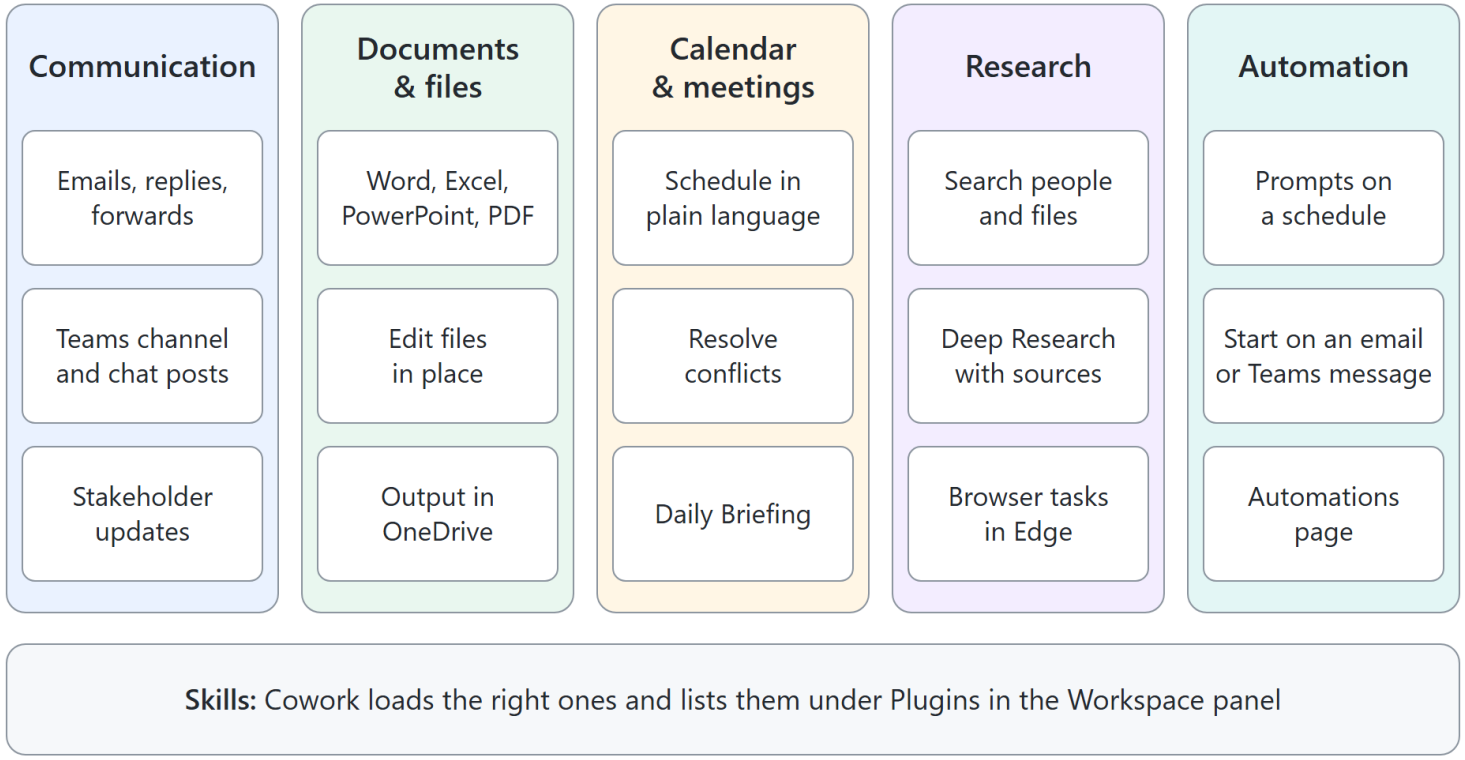
Auto picks the model; you set how hard it works

- **Auto** is the default and picks a model for each task
- One button by the send arrow holds both, e.g. **Auto Medium**
- Effort runs from **Light** to **Max**, Faster to Smarter
- Higher effort is more thorough, slower and uses more credits
- The picker keeps your last choice on that device



Core capabilities

Communication, documents, calendar, research and automation



Skills that Cowork loads on its own back every capability; the later topics go deeper

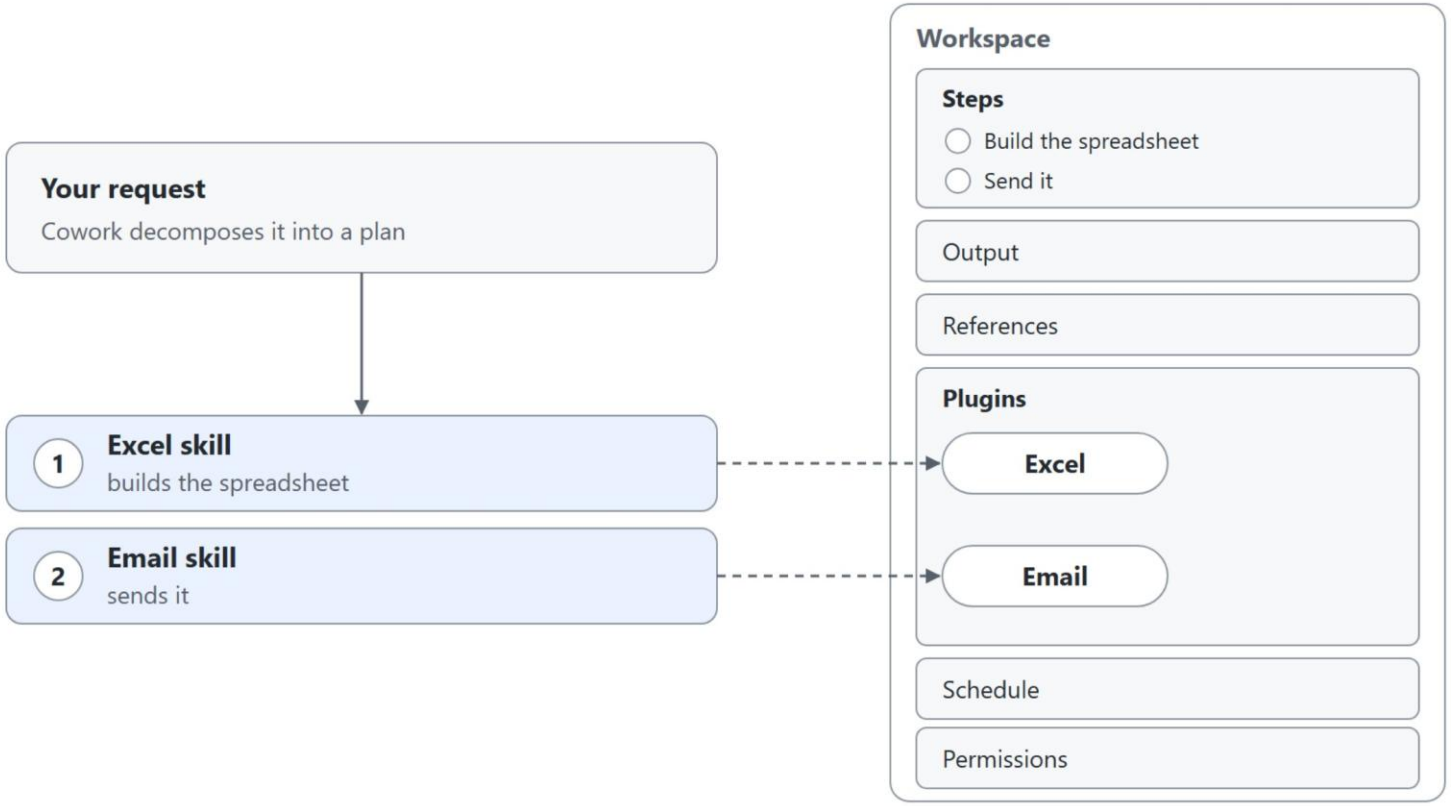
02

Understanding Skills: Built-in Skills & the Side Panel

The built-in catalog and the Workspace panel

Built-in skills and the Workspace panel

Cowork picks the skills; the panel shows them at work

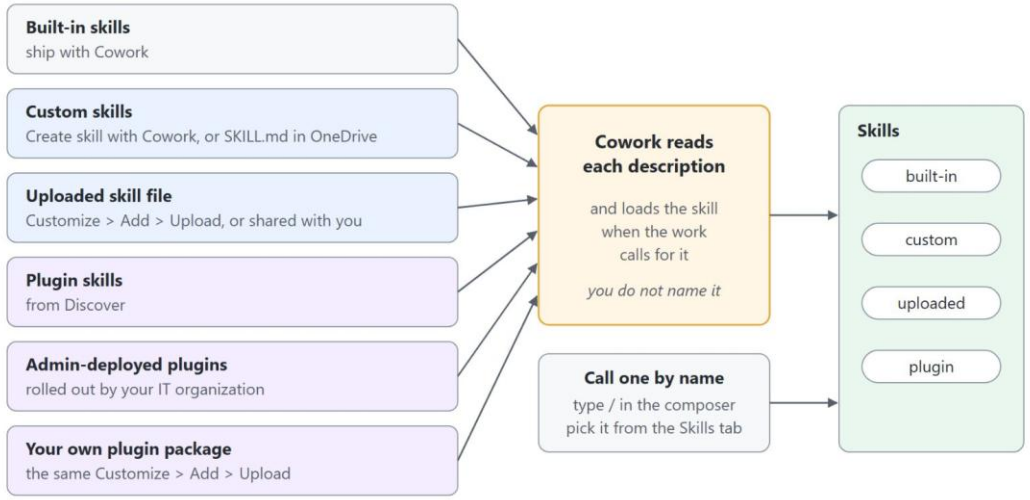


- Each skill Cowork loads for a step appears under **Plugins** in the Workspace panel, beside Steps, Output and References

Where skills come from

Built-in, custom and plugin skills load the same way

- **Create** a skill with Customize > Add > Create skill with Cowork, or as a `SKILL.md` in OneDrive
- **Upload** a skill file with Customize > Add > Upload, or use one a colleague shares
- **Plugins** come from Discover, from your IT organization, or as your own uploaded package
- Cowork **reads each description** and loads the skill when the work calls for it
- Type **/** in the composer to call a skill by name from the Skills tab

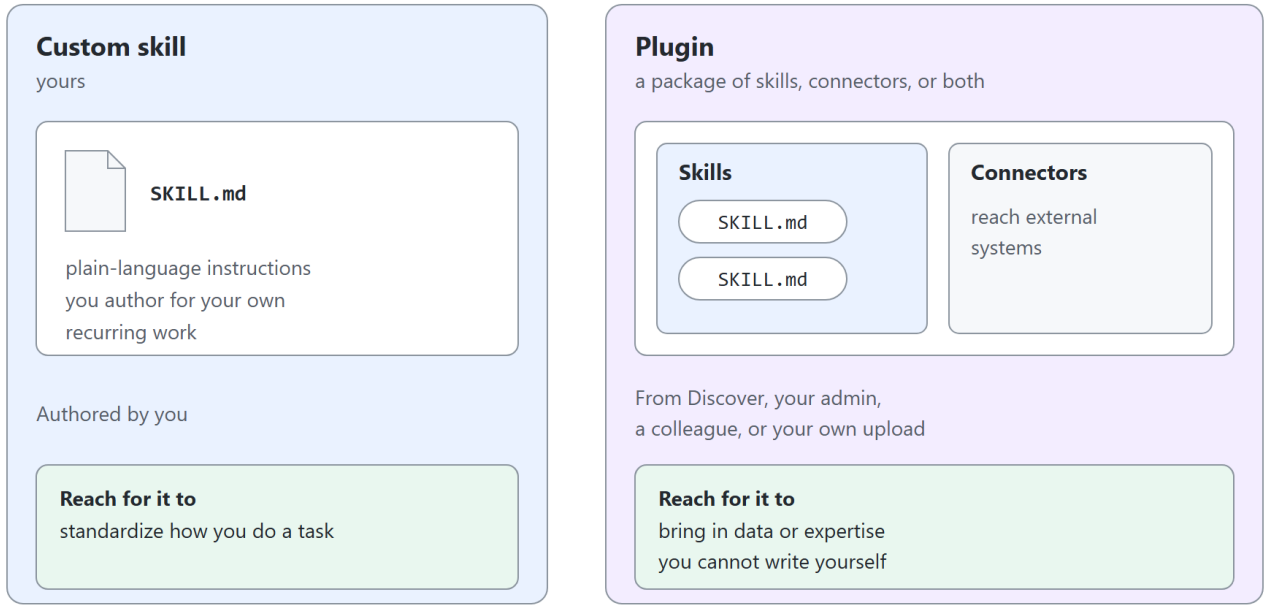


Note: Your own skills are saved in OneDrive under Documents/Cowork/Skills/<name>/SKILL.md. Plugins are not OneDrive files: they are Microsoft 365 app packages under Customize > Plugins.

Where Skills are stored

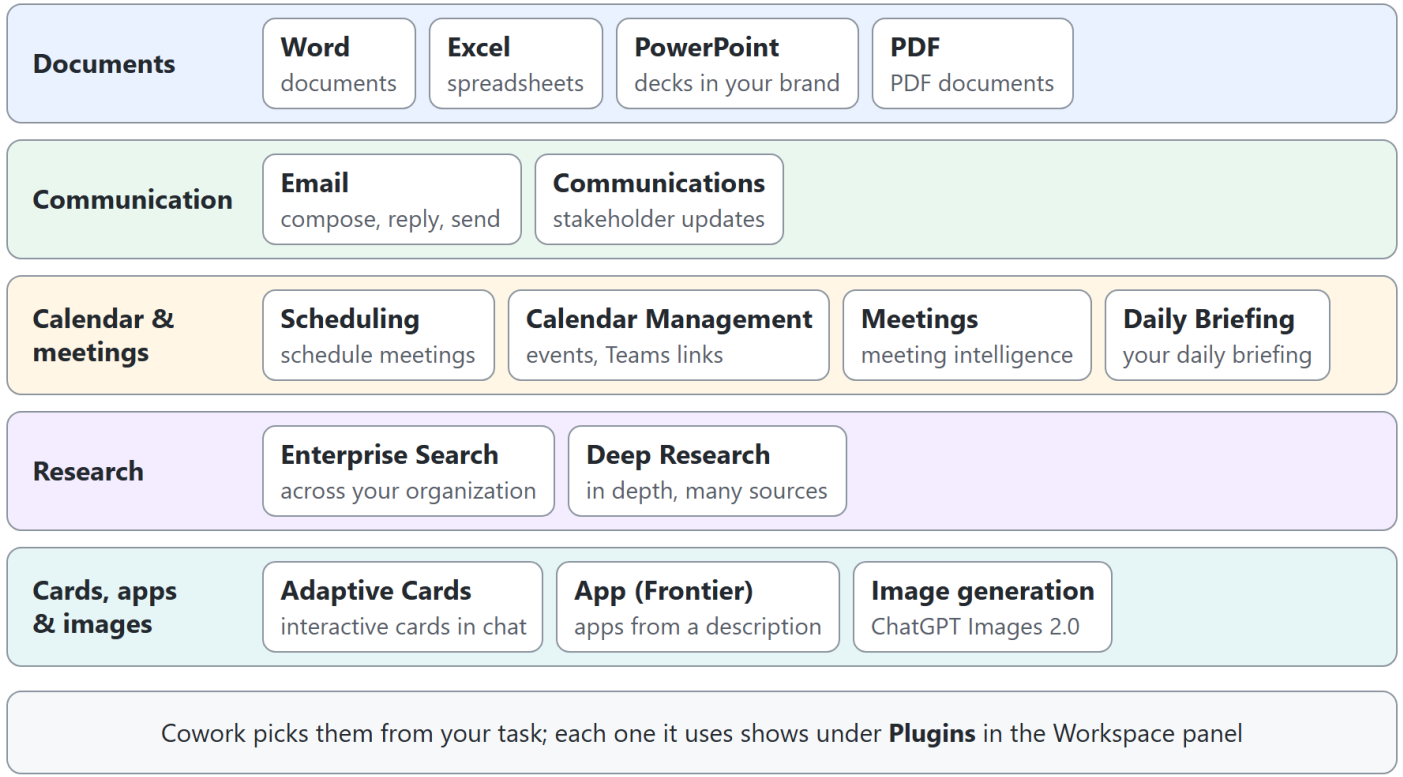
Your OneDrive, or inside a plugin's app package

- **Personal custom skills** are stored in your OneDrive
- Microsoft does not document a fixed user-visible folder path
- **Plugin skills** are stored inside the plugin's app package
- In the package: skills/<name>/SKILL.md
- **Customize** > **Skills**: personal, built-in and plugin skills



The built-in skills

Fifteen skills that ship with Cowork, in five groups

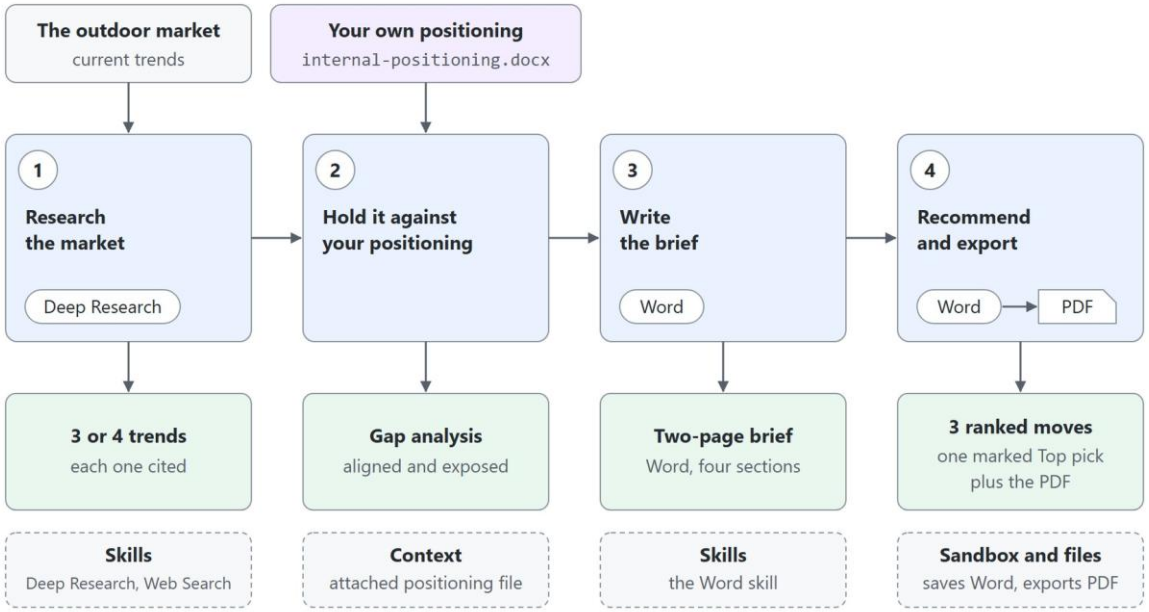


They cover the most common office tasks, and one task often loads several

Producing a market brief

Deep Research, your positioning, then a Word brief and a PDF

- **Deep Research** surveys the European outdoor market in a background task of about four minutes
- `internal-positioning.docx` turns the trends into an **aligned and exposed** gap analysis
- The **Word** skill writes AW26 Market Brief - Aurora Outdoor in four sections
- **Recommendations** rank three moves and mark one Top pick
- One background task saves the `.docx` and exports the **PDF** for leadership



03

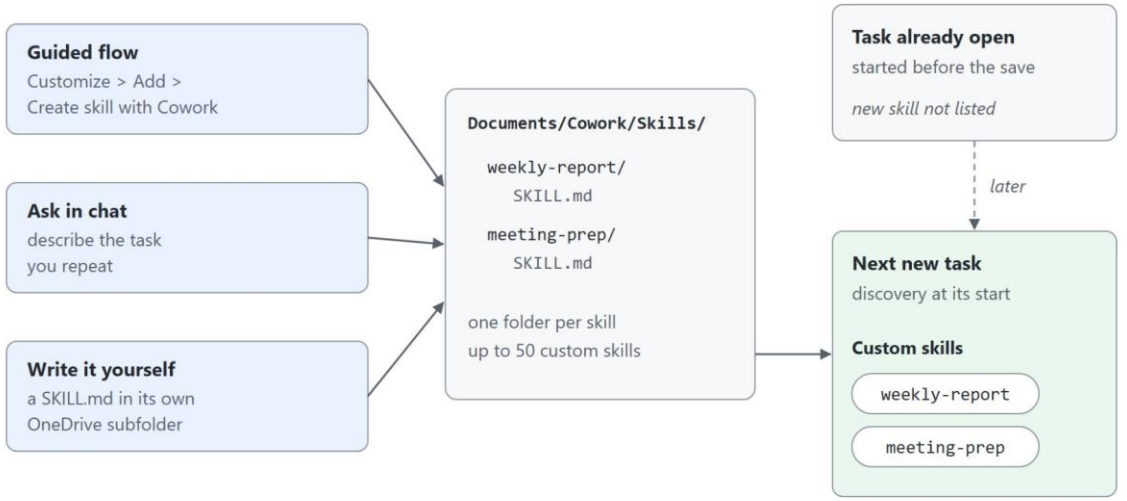
Creating Custom Skills with SKILL.md

Your own skills in plain language

Three ways to create a skill

Every path ends in one OneDrive folder

- **Guided flow**: Customize > Add > Create skill with Cowork
- **Ask in chat**: describe the task you repeat
- **Write it yourself**: a `SKILL.md` in its own folder under `Documents/Cowork/Skills/`
- Cowork **discovers** your skills at the start of each conversation, up to 50
- **Upload** a `.md`, `.zip` or `.skill` file and share it with specific users



The SKILL.md frontmatter

Two required fields: name and description

- **name** and **description** are required in every SKILL.md
- **name**: kebab-case, up to 64 characters, same as the folder
- **description**: up to 1,024 characters, with trigger phrases

```
---
name: weekly-report
description: Generates a weekly status report
  from my recent emails and calendar.
---
```

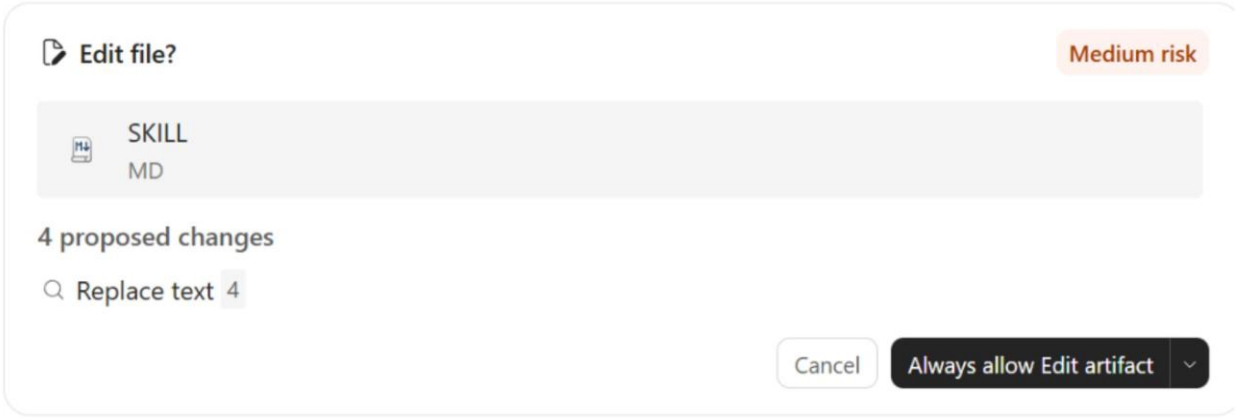
Required

`name`	1 to 64 characters, kebab-case, the same as the folder name
`description`	1 to 1,024 characters: what it does and when, with trigger phrases

Running and tuning a skill

From the first run to a skill that triggers on its own

- **Run it by name** in a new task, then check every claim against the source
- Ask which phrasings **miss the skill** and which instruction let weak claims through
- Cowork folds the fixes into `SKILL.md` through an **Edit file?** card at Medium risk
- The **Skill Report** scores the skill out of 100; 70 counts as ready to share
- Done when it **fires without being named** and saves Aurora Trail Capsule AW26.pptx



04

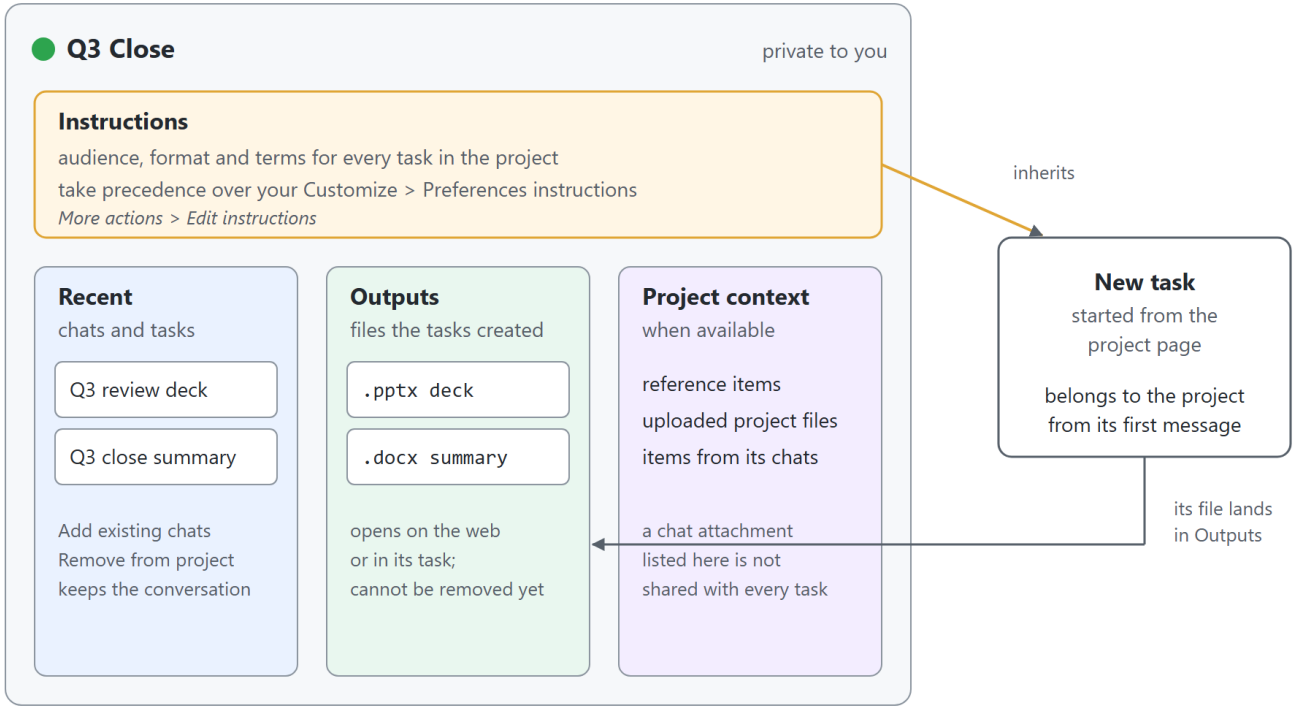
Organizing Work with Projects

Tasks, instructions and outputs in one place

What a project holds

Instructions, Recent, Outputs and Project context

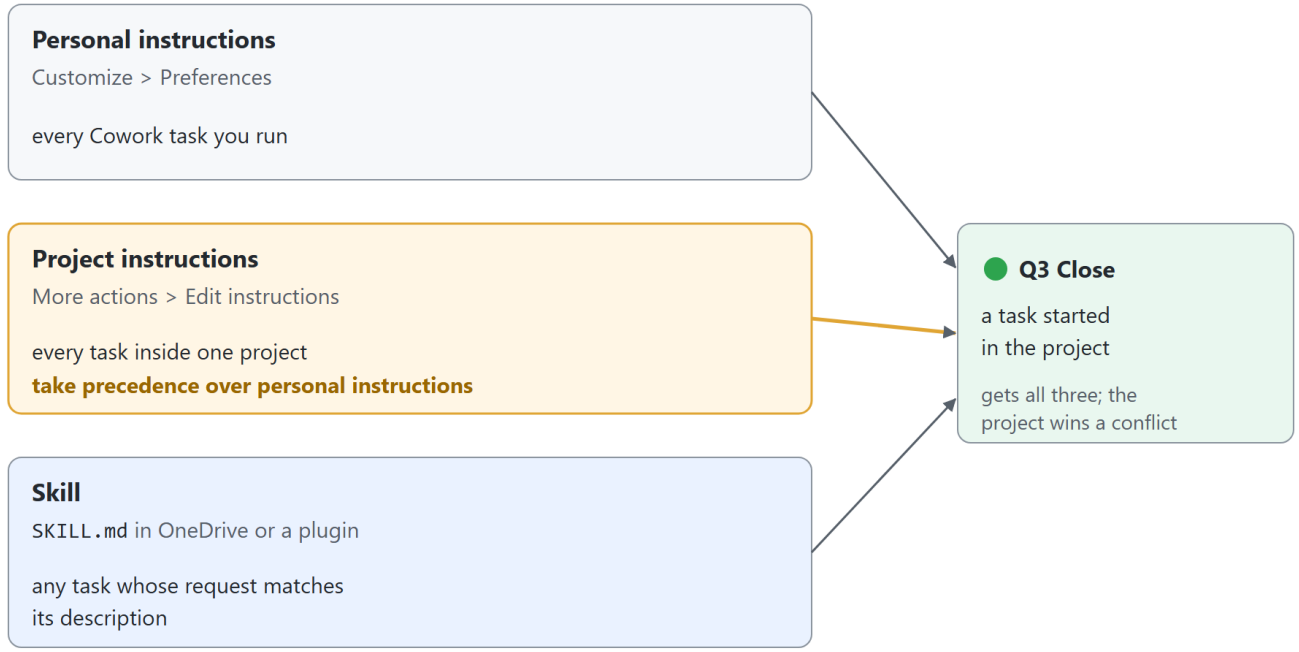
- A **project** keeps related tasks, instructions and files together
- Projects are **private** to the person who creates them
- **Recent** lists its chats and tasks, **Outputs** their files
- **Project context** holds reference items and uploaded files
- Start a task **from the project page** so it belongs from message one



Project instructions take precedence

Personal, project and skill: three layers on one task

- Set them with **More actions** > **Edit instructions** > **Save**
- They name the **audience**, the **format** and the **terms** to keep
- They apply to **every task inside the project**
- They win over your **Customize** > **Preferences** instructions
- A **skill** carries a procedure across all your projects



05

Scheduled Prompts & Event-Driven Tasks

On a schedule or when a message arrives

Good candidates for automation

Recurring reports and incoming messages

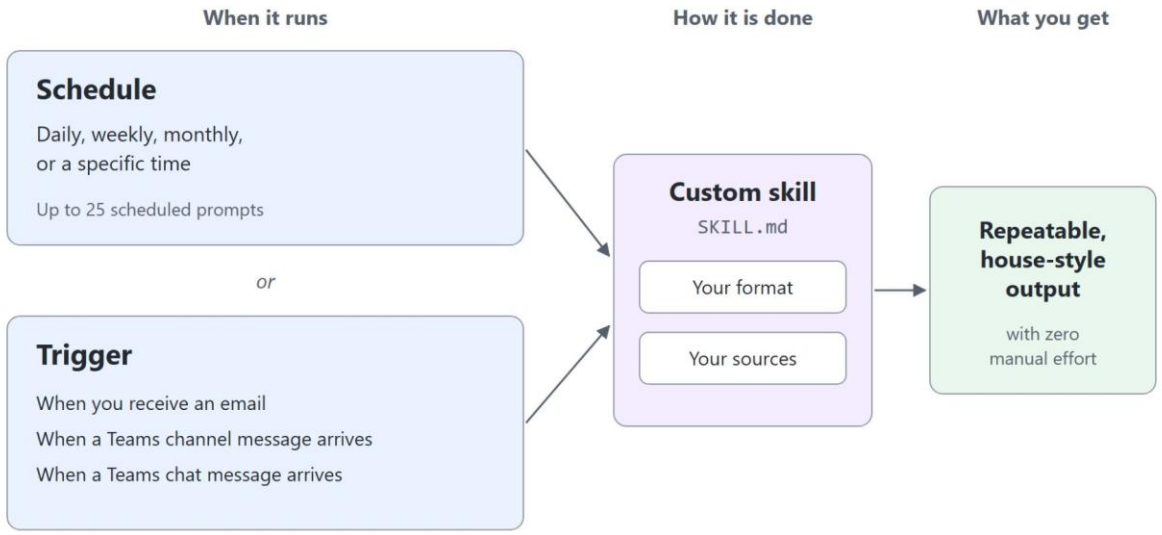
- Every weekday at 8 AM, a **Daily Briefing** of meetings, priority emails and newly shared documents
- Every Friday at 4 PM, a Word **status report** on your week for your manager
- On the first of the month, a one-page **digest** of the Marketing Teams channel
- When your manager emails about supplier delays, a **summary and draft reply** for your review
- When you are @mentioned in the Aurora Outdoor Operations channel, a **one-line summary** by email



Schedules and triggers

Repeat a prompt on a cadence or when something happens

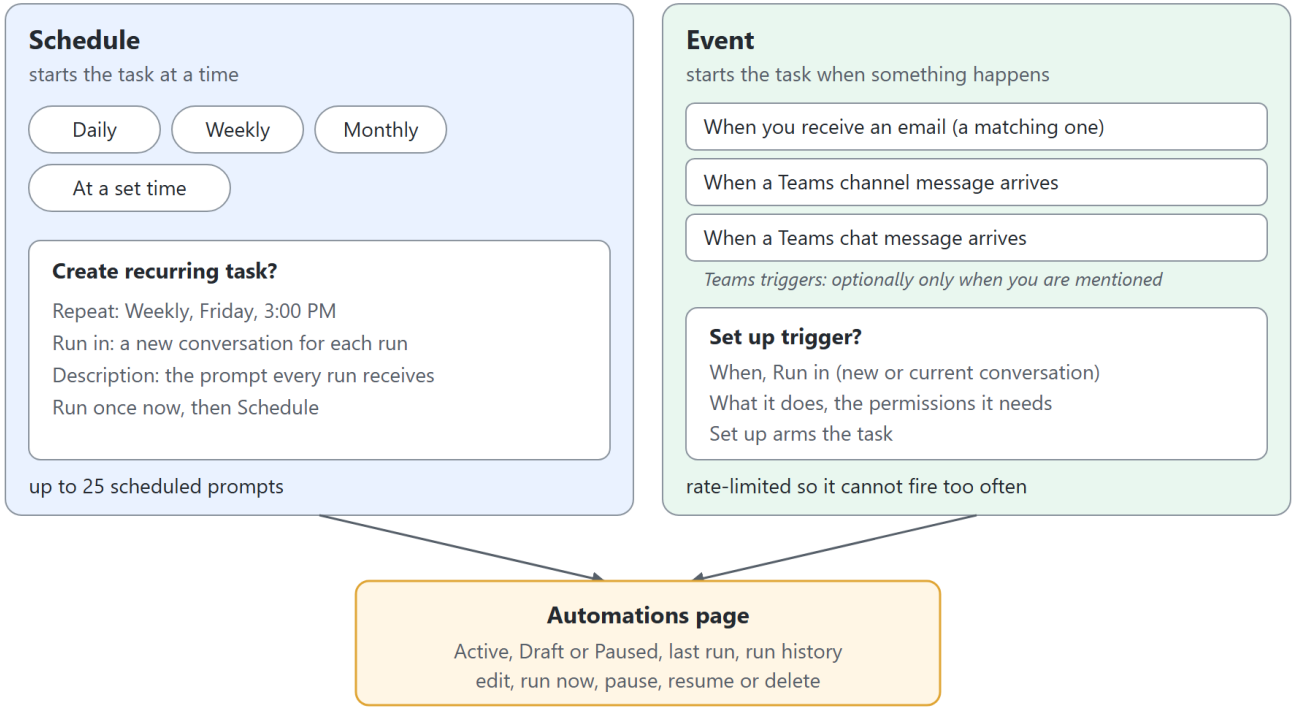
- A **schedule** repeats a prompt daily, weekly, monthly or at a set time, up to 25 of them
- A **trigger** starts the task when an email, a Teams channel message or a Teams chat message arrives
- The **Automations** page offers Add, templates such as Daily briefing, and the filters Scheduled, Triggers and Paused
- Each automation has an **Enable** switch and a … menu to edit, run now, pause or delete it
- The **custom skill** decides how the work is done; the schedule or trigger decides when



Trigger types

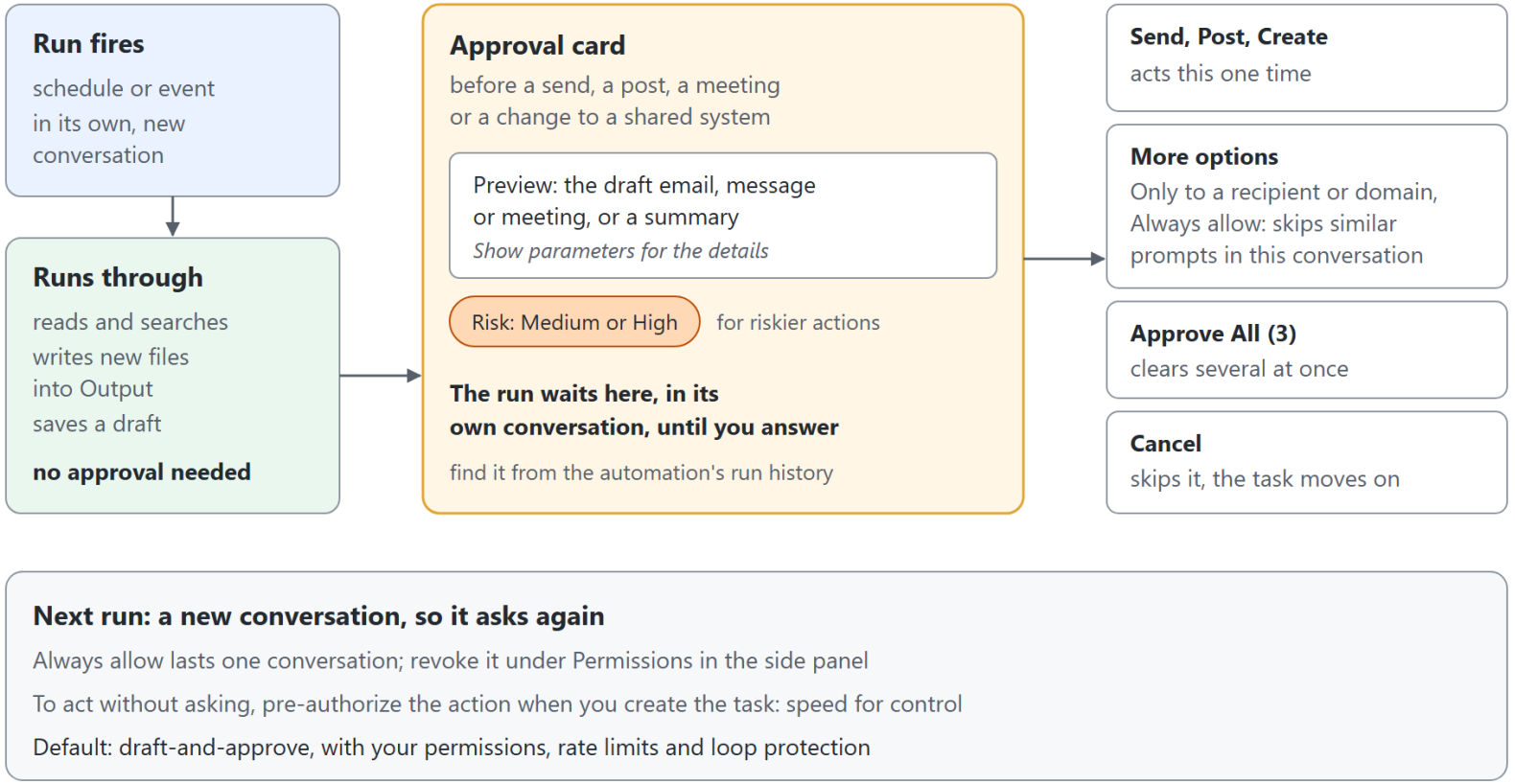
A schedule starts it at a time, an event when something happens

- A **schedule** runs daily, weekly, monthly or at a set time
- **Create recurring task?** starts a new conversation for each run
- An **email** trigger fires on a matching email you receive
- **Teams** triggers fire on channel or chat messages
- Teams triggers can react only to messages that **mention you**



How approvals work in a run

The run prepares the work, then waits on the card for you

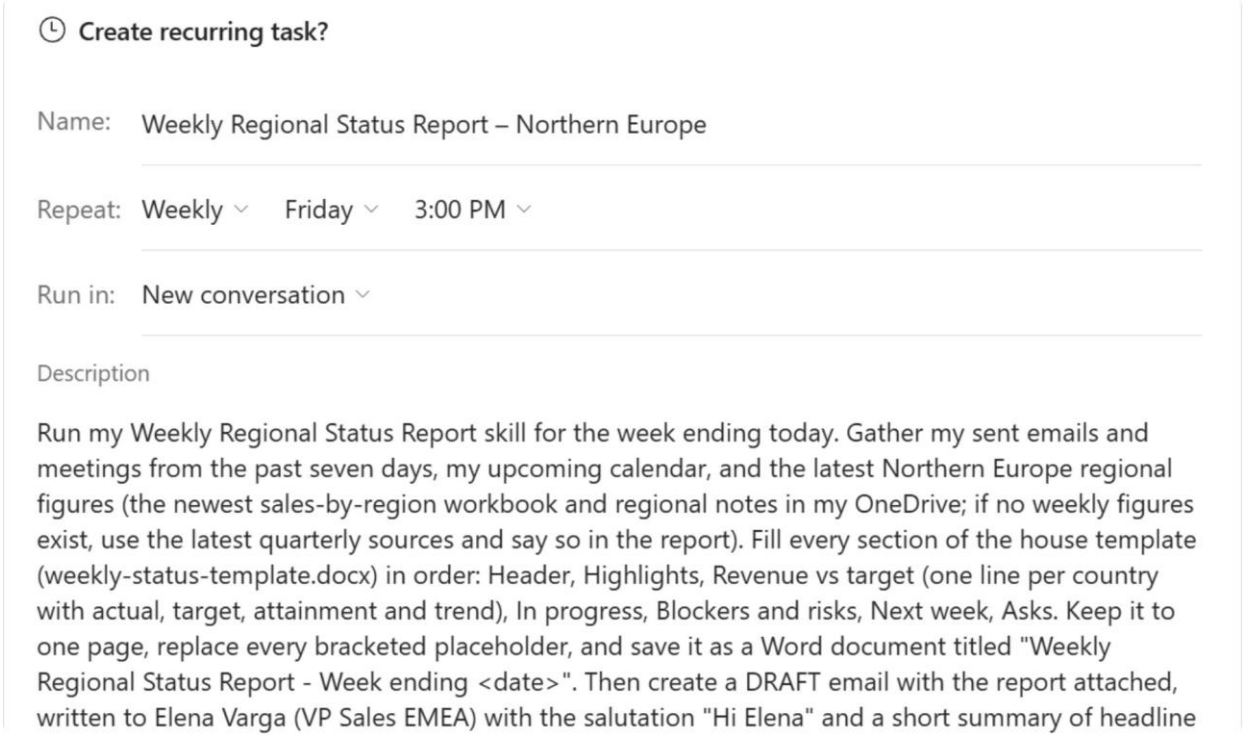


Always allow lasts one conversation; each new run asks again unless pre-authorized

Approvals in automated tasks

The weekly status report runs every Friday; the send waits for you

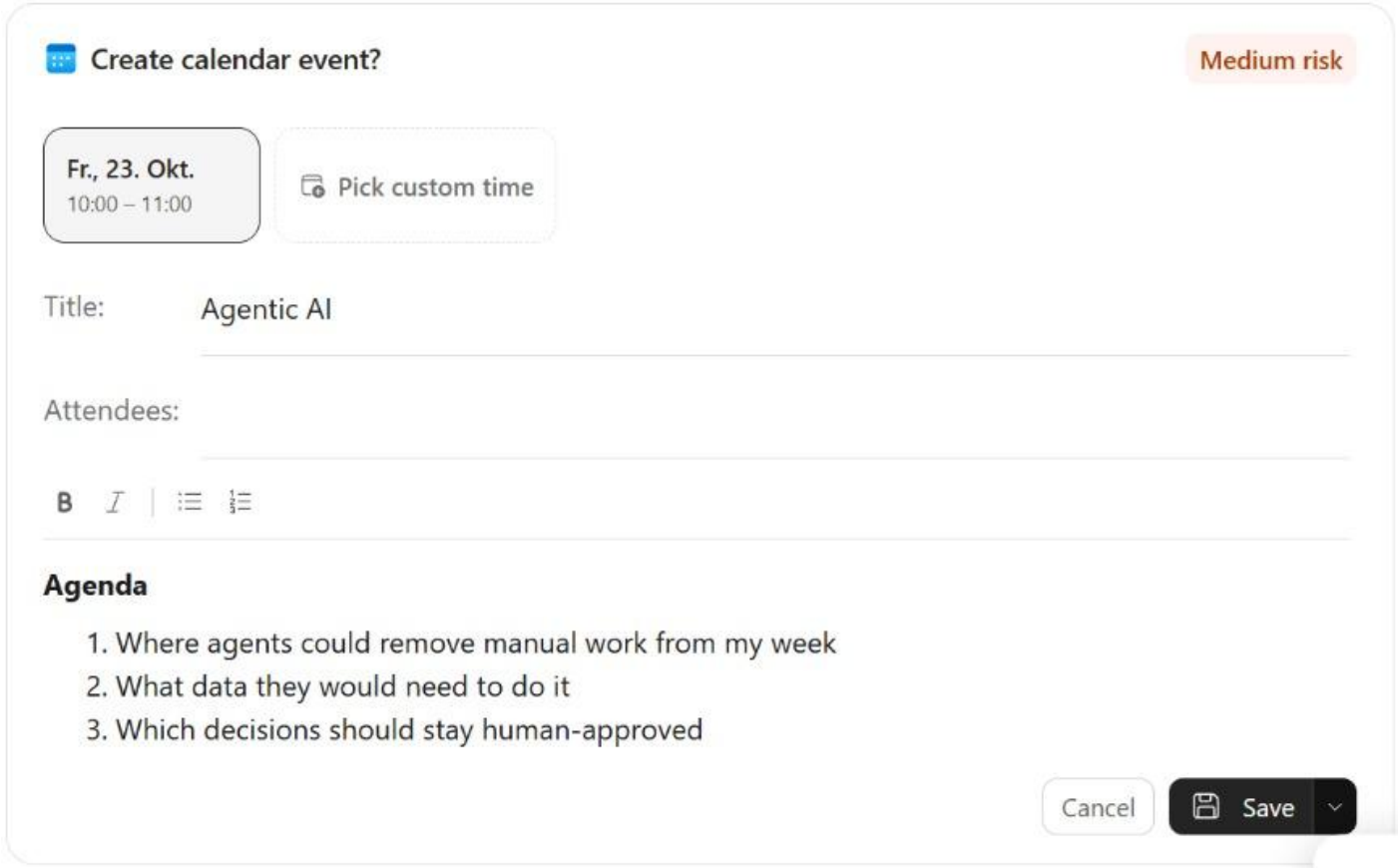
- **Create recurring task?** sets the name, Weekly, Friday, 3:00 PM, and a new conversation per run
- The **Description** is the prompt every run receives, including where the draft goes
- **Run once now** is ticked by default; clear it so the first run waits for Friday
- Each run leaves the report under Output and a **Hi Elena** email in your Drafts folder
- **Scheduling the run does not approve the send**: nothing leaves until you say so



The approval model

Cowork pauses before anything that leaves your workspace

- The card names the action as a question, here **Create calendar event?**, and shows what it will write
- **Save** approves this one action, and the task records Approved 1 action
- The arrow beside it offers **Always allow Create event** for the rest of the session
- **Medium risk** changes your content or calendar; **high risk** reaches other people
- New files in Output and saved drafts need **no approval**



06

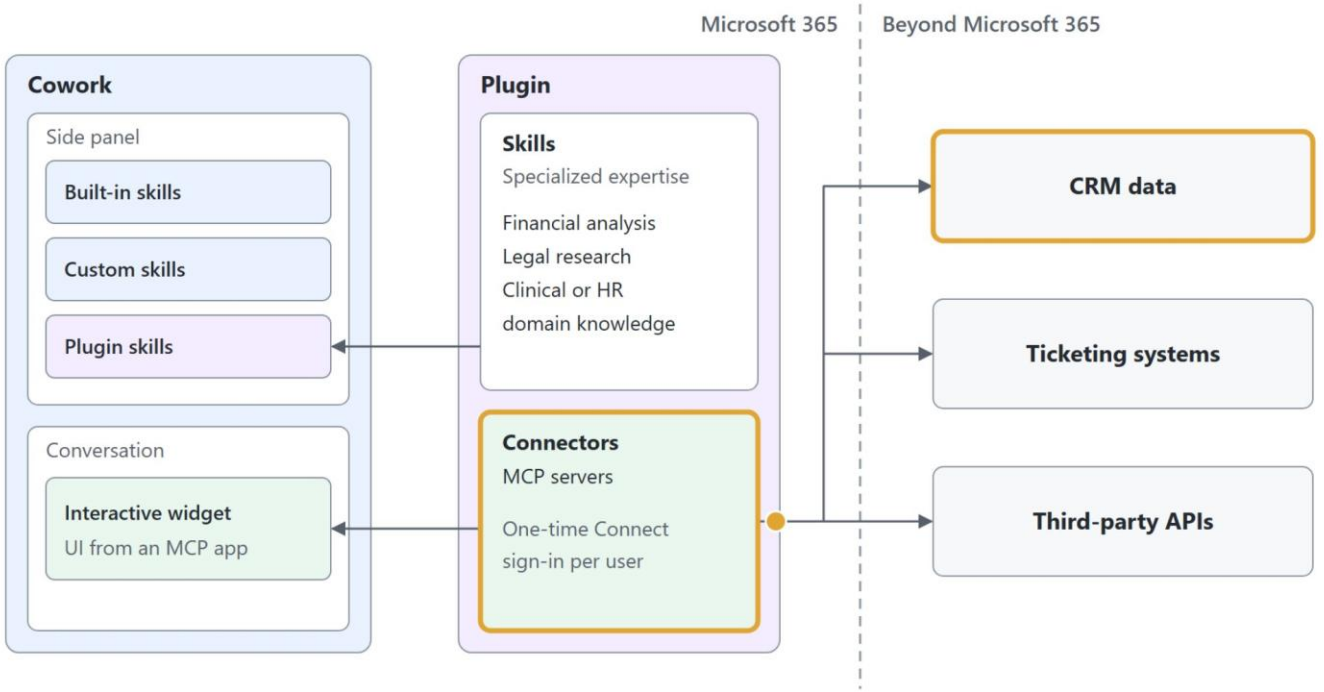
Extending Cowork with Plugins

Outside data and expertise from plugins

What plugins add

Skills and connectors that reach beyond Microsoft 365

- Skills with **specialized expertise**: financial analysis, legal research, clinical or HR knowledge
- **MCP connectors** reach CRM data, ticketing systems and third-party APIs
- Each user completes a one-time **Connect** sign-in
- An **MCP app** returns an interactive widget into the conversation
- Plugins your admin rolls out show **Managed by your organization**

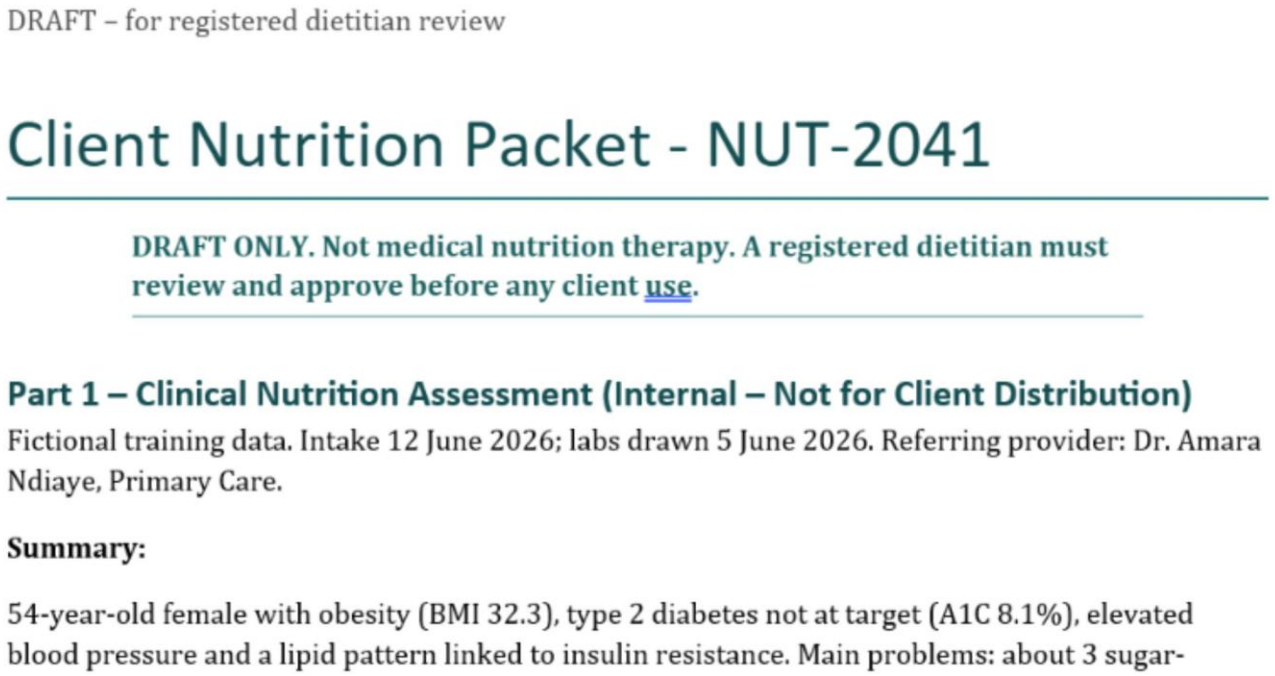


Note: Plugins are not saved in OneDrive. They are Microsoft 365 app packages: Customize > Plugins shows Installed, Discover and the plugins shared with you, and admins manage them in the Microsoft 365 admin center.

Where plugins fit

The dietitian plugin's skills beside the built-in Word skill

- **Upload** the dietitian package under Customize > Add > Upload and publish it to Only you
- Its skills **clinical-nutrition** and **dietary-communication** draft the assessment and the client handout
- Each loads with a **Reviewed custom skill** step and joins **Plugins** next to the built-in Word
- **Word** compiles both drafts into Client Nutrition Packet - NUT-2041, the DRAFT ONLY line on top
- Sharing with specific people needs **no admin**; the whole organization waits for admin approval



DRAFT – for registered dietitian review

Client Nutrition Packet - NUT-2041

DRAFT ONLY. Not medical nutrition therapy. A registered dietitian must review and approve before any client use.

Part 1 – Clinical Nutrition Assessment (Internal – Not for Client Distribution)

Fictional training data. Intake 12 June 2026; labs drawn 5 June 2026. Referring provider: Dr. Amara Ndiaye, Primary Care.

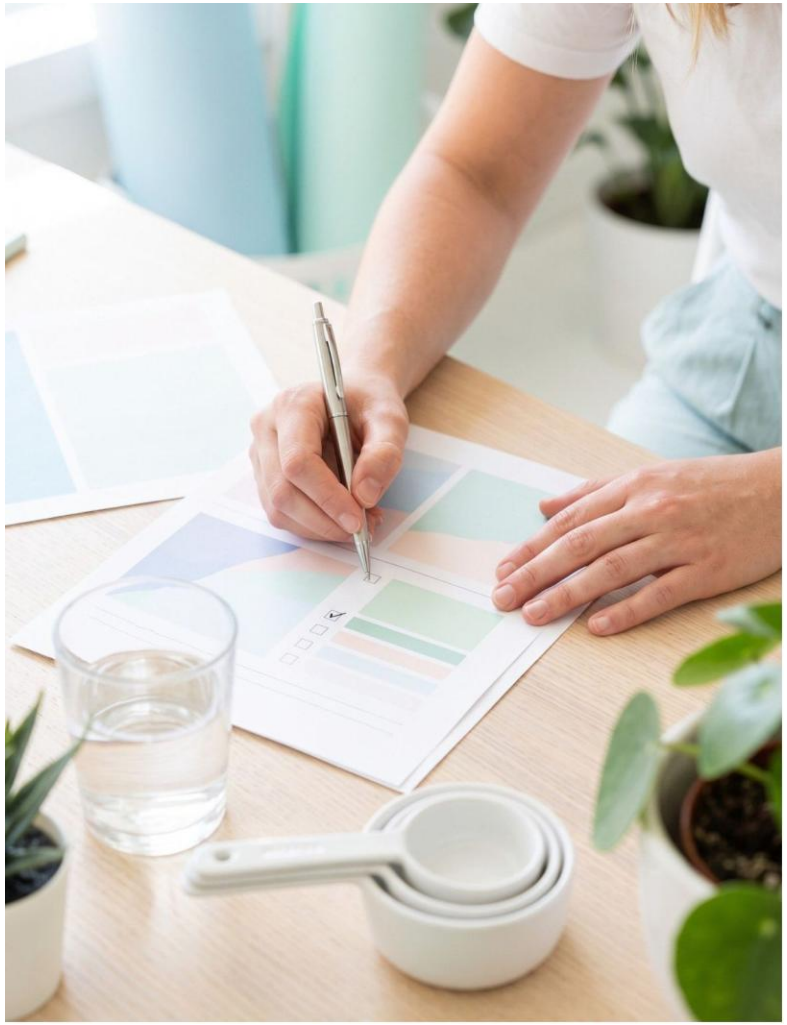
Summary:

54-year-old female with obesity (BMI 32.3), type 2 diabetes not at target (A1C 8.1%), elevated blood pressure and a lipid pattern linked to insulin resistance. Main problems: about 3 sugar-

Reviewing plugin output

The plugin drafts; the dietitian decides

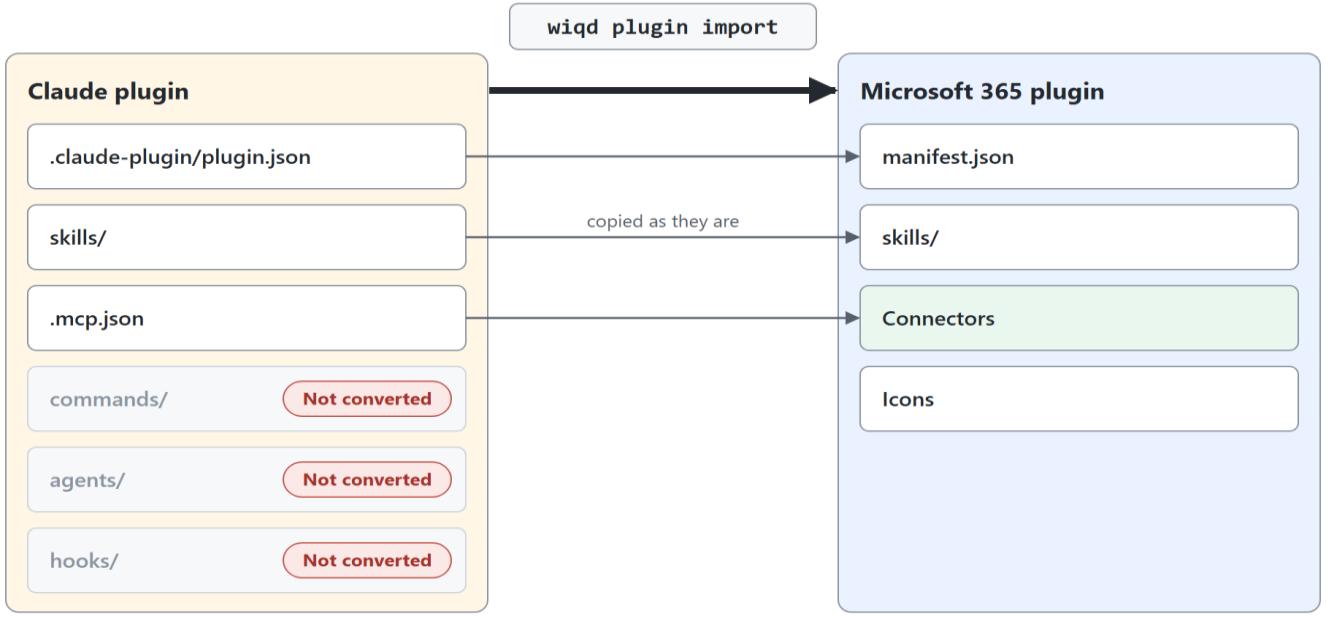
A registered dietitian reviews and approves every packet before any of it reaches a client



Import a Claude plugin

One command turns a Claude plugin into a Microsoft 365 plugin

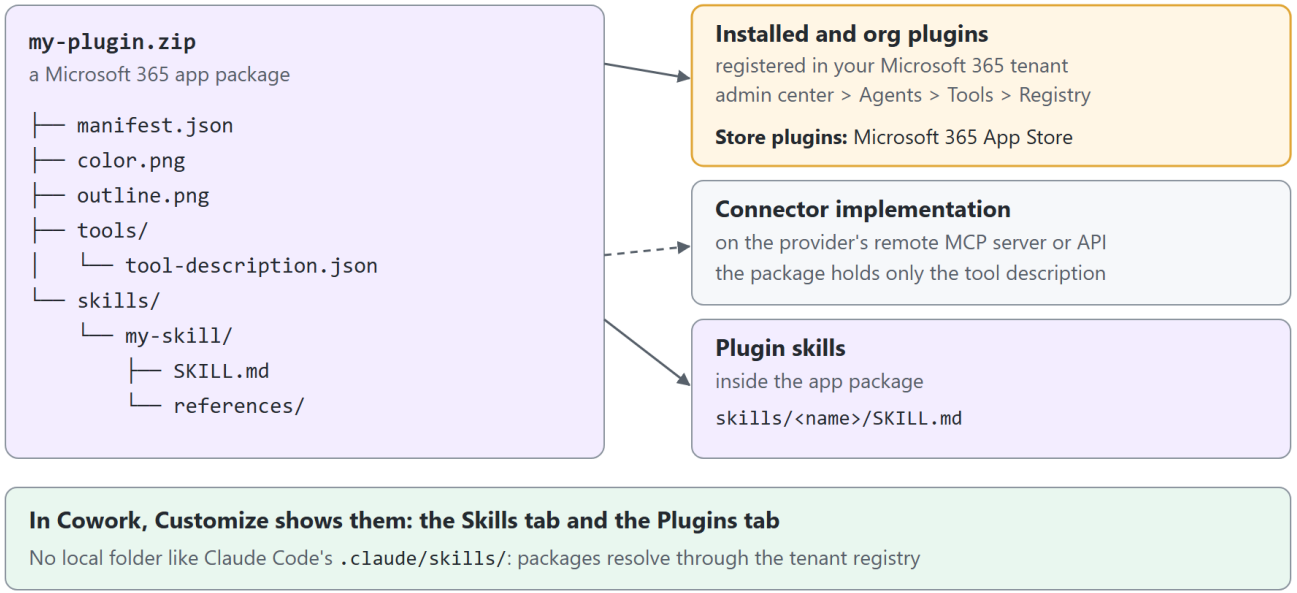
- **wiqd plugin import** reads a Claude, Cursor or Open Plugin folder and creates a Microsoft 365 plugin project
- **Skills** are copied as they are, and MCP servers from .mcp.json become **connectors**
- Slash commands, sub-agents and hooks are **not converted**
- The first import needs your organization's privacy, terms and website links



Where plugins are stored

App packages, resolved through the tenant registry

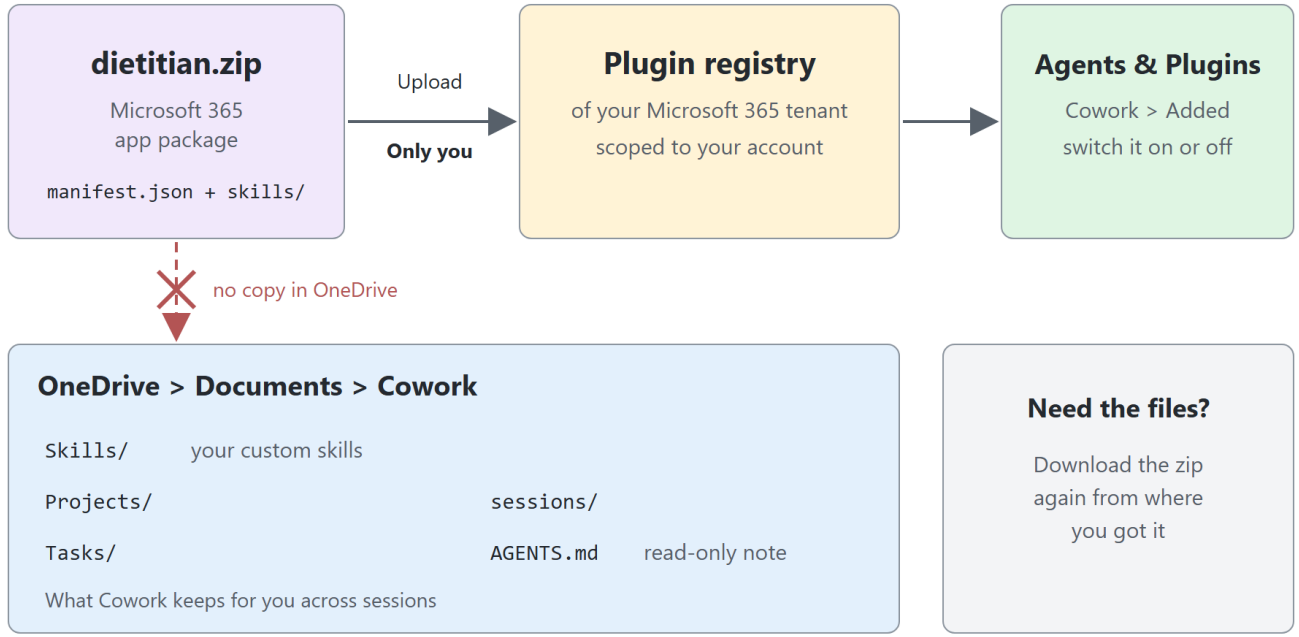
- A plugin is a **Microsoft 365 app package**, typically a ZIP
- **Installed and org plugins** are registered in your tenant
- Admin center > **Agents** > **Tools** > **Registry** manages them
- **Store plugins** come through the Microsoft 365 App Store
- **Connectors** stay on the provider's MCP server or API



Your Cowork folder in OneDrive

Your skills and work live there, uploaded plugins do not

- An uploaded plugin goes to your tenant's **plugin registry**
- **Only you** scopes it to your account, not to a folder
- Find it on **Agents & Plugins** > **Cowork** > **Added**
- Documents/Cowork holds **Skills**, **Projects** and **Tasks**
- Need the files again? Download the **zip** again



Takeaways

From a first task to staying in control

- **Describe the outcome**, and Cowork plans and acts across Microsoft 365
- A **spending policy** that selects Cowork grants access, metered in Copilot Credits
- **Skills** load on their own, and a `SKILL.md` teaches Cowork one of your recurring jobs
- **Schedules, triggers and plugins** make the work recurring and bring in outside expertise
- **You approve** every send, booking and file edit before it leaves your workspace

